

Philipp Hilbert. *Operational clarity at global scale.*

Positioning, Staff PM with 10+ years shipping complex B2B platforms who turns messy operational landscapes into automated, measurable systems, exactly what Deel IT needs next.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY DEEL

Deel IT is not a vendor coordination problem dressed up as software, it is a genuine systems problem where logistics, device lifecycle, supplier incentives, IT support, and financial outcomes are all load-bearing and interdependent. The job description names exactly the kind of challenge I find most legible: a platform that works, surrounded by manual workflows that should not exist, and suppliers who want to do more but lack the structure to act. That gap between what the platform enables and what the operations team still does by hand is a roadmap waiting to be written. What draws me is the sentence "what ships next, and why", that is the question, not a side effect of the question. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

Device lifecycle and IT asset management are not domains I have shipped production features in directly; my operational experience lives in logistics (graduate specialisation), POS and payment infrastructure, and insurance platforms. The transferable mechanic is identical: multi-sided workflows with real SLA consequence, supplier coordination, and the pattern-matching required to spot which manual step is the highest-leverage automation candidate.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude** : research, synthesis, decision documents, edge-case generation
 - **Claude Code** : in-repo refactors, spec-to-implementation loops
 - **GPT** : secondary reasoning pass, cross-checking
 - **Cursor / VSCode** : day-to-day coding environment
 - **Lovable** : rapid UI prototyping for stakeholder validation
 - **n8n** : agentic workflow orchestration, file-queue agent loops
 - **Gamma.app** : decision documents and roadmap presentations
 - **Framer** : design-heavy interface exploration
-

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Kafka, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Dagster, dbt, REST APIs, Docker, Jenkins, Argo Workflows, Terraform.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT DEEL

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with ops, engineering, and two to three suppliers; pull ticket patterns, SLA breach logs, and the engineering backlog; map every human-in-the-loop step against its estimated volume and failure cost to produce a ranked shortlist of automation candidates.

WEEK 2

Validate and slice.

Take the top three candidates back to ops and engineering for a gut-check on effort versus impact, collapse scope to the smallest shippable unit that proves the hypothesis, and draft the first roadmap arc with explicit success metrics.

Ship, measure, close loops.

Drive the first automation to production, instrument it, and use the measured outcome to sharpen the next bet, maintaining a live dashboard of on-time delivery rate, ticket response time, and revenue per ops headcount as the standing accountability layer.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Deel IT team,

I am applying for the Staff PM, Deel IT role because the problem description is one I can read in systems terms immediately: a platform that handles real scale, a layer of manual workflows sitting on top of it that should not exist, and a supplier network that is incentive-aligned but structurally underserved. Those three things together are not a gap, they are a compounding drag on unit economics that only gets more expensive as the operation grows. The role asks for someone who can diagnose that drag, rank the interventions, and drive them to production without being handed a map. That is work I have done repeatedly, in different domains, and I want to do it here.

At Rohde & Schwarz I inherited an AI and data platform that was technically sound but operationally brittle, deployment cycles measured in days, manual steps baked into every release, and a multinational engineering team that had been blocked by an infrastructure problem for over a year. I diagnosed the constraint, restructured the pipeline, and brought deployment time from several days to twenty to forty minutes. The lever was not more engineering effort; it was identifying the one blocker that cascaded into everything else and removing it first. The process of getting there, pulling data from multiple sources, forming a clear hypothesis, and defending a prioritisation call against experienced architects, is the same process the Deel IT role is asking for, applied to a logistics and supplier context rather than a defence data pipeline.

At EMIL Group I took on a 17-person delivery organisation that had stalled and was losing its senior engineers. The root cause was not skill; it was that teams were executing tickets without owning outcomes. I restructured the organisation into units that could own a surface end to end, rebuilt the feedback loop between discovery and delivery, and instrumented the claim flow so that churn per process step became the prioritisation signal rather than stakeholder preference. Velocity returned, client trust returned, and an almost complete exodus stopped. The pattern the Deel IT role describes, ops teams, engineering, suppliers, and finance as four distinct worlds that need translation between them, is a familiar coordination topology, and restructuring the feedback loop between them is where I add the most leverage.

On automation specifically: my approach is AI-native rather than AI-augmented. I run a multi-agent framework for my own product work in which coordinator, implementer, and evaluator agents operate a shared queue under guardrails I designed. I use Claude Code, Cursor, n8n, and Lovable daily, not as productivity tools but as structural components of how I scope, prototype, and validate. When the job description says "AI-native as your default, not a nice-to-have," I read that as a statement about how the team thinks, not a checkbox, and it matches how I already operate.

The scope here, logistics, device lifecycle, IT support, supplier networks, SLAs, and the financial layer underneath all of it, is large, and that is the point. I am drawn to roles where the roadmap has to be earned rather than inherited, and where the cost of a slow decision is visible to the whole company. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss where the highest-leverage intervention sits right now, and what shipping the first automation would prove.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Philipp Hilbert is a product manager with over ten years of experience owning complex, multi-sided B2B platforms from discovery through production. His background spans logistics infrastructure, insurance platforms, defence data pipelines, payment systems, and national-scale analytics, consistently in environments where the cost of a slow decision was measurable and the roadmap had to be earned rather than received. He works AI-native as a structural habit, runs his own multi-agent framework, and treats deployment, observability, and supplier coordination as product concerns rather than engineering details. He is drawn to roles with real operational complexity, genuine autonomy, and a north star that can be instrumented.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Roadmap diagnosis from first principles, without a map handed over
- Systems thinking across logistics, supplier networks, ops, and finance
- Automation scoping: finding the manual step with the highest leverage
- Translating operational complexity into clean, well-scoped engineering work
- AI-native execution: multi-agent orchestration, prompt engineering, daily AI tooling
- Stakeholder alignment across ops, engineering, suppliers, and finance simultaneously

- Instrumentation-first delivery: define success before building, observe it after
 - Fast feedback loops: ship at 80% certainty, measure, adjust
 - Cross-functional team restructuring to restore velocity and ownership
-

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 2025, PRESENT

Product Manager, B2B Marketplace for the Construction Industry

- Owned zero-to-one product vision and strategy for a two-sided B2B marketplace, coordinating three distinct user groups, contractors, workers, and internal operations
- Designed full AI-assisted internal workflow so that one operator can run the entire day-to-day business operation, minimising internal headcount cost
- Mapped and optimised user journeys across all three sides of the marketplace, including the constraint that the business must run inside the channels users actually live in

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI and Data Platform (FCAS defence programme)

- Owned a module of the central AI backbone for a European defence programme end to end: requirements, backlog, release definition, rollout
- Diagnosed an infrastructure deployment blocker that engineering had not resolved in over a year; reduced deployment times from several days to 20 to 40 minutes
- Delivered reproducible pipelines with complete provenance and audit trails for safety-critical use across a multinational team of architects, data scientists, engineers, and QA
- Steered cross-functional delivery across geographies under real SLA and compliance constraints

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Data and Analytics Platform

- Owned a national analytics platform on a warehouse-grade ETL stack used by policy makers and researchers across Germany
- Introduced automated ETL orchestration and standardised CI/CD, removing manual steps from the release pipeline
- Deputy IT security officer: compliance, governance, and data lineage under a recurring audit cycle

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, B2B SaaS Platform

- Restructured a 17-person delivery organisation into teams that could own a surface end to end; restored velocity and client trust, stopping an almost complete senior engineer exodus
- Built a claims module from zero with no specification and no internal precedent, running discovery directly with a pilot customer's claim specialists
- Instrumented the claim flow so that churn per process step became the standing prioritisation signal
- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, and document workflow automation

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Application (iOS and Android)

- Shipped a hospital application across two platforms for multiple distinct user groups
- Implemented the interface into the incumbent clinical system landscape directly, without a separate integration team
- Cut an overambitious roadmap to the most important ten percent of features, restoring delivery pace

BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021

Product Owner, National Health Data Platform

- Owned secure data structures and identity management for national pandemic monitoring programmes under the highest privacy and compliance requirements

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN 2020, 2021

Product Owner, Integration Team (Fuel and Convenience Retail)

- Owned the integration team backlog downstream of research, turning research outcomes into releasable integration across site and head-office systems
- Managed PI planning, release train coordination, and cross-team dependency management in a fully SAlFe organisation across geographies and disciplines

AOK ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of an internal procurement platform serving roughly 20,000 employees across three regional health insurers, with catalogue and API integration into legacy systems and per-unit approval workflows

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder and CFO

- Built a mobile payments platform from zero: PSP integration, settlement flows, onboarding, and full user experience; acquired and operated by Sparkasse
- Owned accounting, financial planning, and investor reporting as CFO

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder and Product Owner

- Shipped quantum-secure encryption across a three-layer hardware and software architecture to enterprise customers under a sub-two-minute installation constraint
- Owned product architecture for backup, restore, checkpoint, and data-encryption surfaces

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO and CFO

- Took a nanotechnology product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned finance, HR, and the ERP rollout

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)